Parks Commission Recreation - Report 10/14/2026

Dunbar Community Center

- **Attendance**: 2026 – 1,978

Youth Programs

- **Star Student Afterschool:** 60 enrolled

Youth Athletics

- **Youth Flag Football:** 32 enrolled; league ended September 29 and were played at West Central
- **Cheer:** 15 enrolled – practice @DCC and cheered @8U Flag Football games in September.
- **Youth Volleyball**: 26 enrolled: practice Monday - Thursday (6 – 7:30pm), league to begin in October
- **Special Activities:** Youth Flag football/Cheerleading end of season Awards, LRPR Star Student-Water Safety program ended September 24.

Adult& Senior Programs

- **Dunbar Line Dancing:** Manday/Tuesday. (cost $10/$3 senior monthly/day, $15/$5 Adult monthly/day)

Community Use: Outdoor tennis courts and park areas used for recreation and fitness.

Facility Vacancies: 2-Part-Time Activity Assistant, 1- Part-time Time Custodian.

Meetings: NAACP meeting with 30 in attendance. (September 3rd), Gibbs Elementary Pep Rally with 387 in attendance. (September 4th), City of Little Rock Parks and Recreation meeting with 17 in attendance. (September 10th), Dunbar Garden meeting with 4 in attendance. (September 11th), Little Rock School District engagement with 46 in attendance. (September 22nd), City Manager meeting with 8 in attendance. (September 28th)

Facility Improvements (Planned): Paint banquet hall walls and add a larger TV in arts/craft room.

Cooling Center: Monday through Friday, 8 a.m. to 8:30 p.m. & Saturday 9 a.m. to 5 p.m.

Southwest Community Center

Cooling Center: Monday through Friday, 8 a.m. to 8:30 p.m. & Saturday 9 a.m. to 5 p.m.

Youth Programs:

- **Free Art Night:** Wednesdays from 6pm-8pm, monthly membership.
- **Home School Recreation Hour:** Program registration began August 3rd and will remain open until further notice
- **Junior Botanist Program:** Partnered with Dunbar Gardens with an average of 10 potential Jr. Botanist attending. It is in the process of seeking funding to provide education to participants throughout year by hiring an instructor to guide youth through weekly sessions.
- **SW Beehives Beekeepers Program:** Involves caring for, managing, and inspecting honeybee colonies. It also includes collecting/processing honey, providing bees with a safe environment, and enough food. The program has 4 youth participants to meet on September 9. They learned the different components of beehive and were able to visit the beehive with their veils and beekeeper equipment. Next meeting is scheduled for October 1, 2026, at Dee Brown library.
- **Southwest Builds**: Is open for ages 13+. First meeting was Sept. 16, 4 participants were introduced to basic tools, proper handling, and hands-on skills. As it grows, so will its impact, with future plans to take on real-world community improvement projects.
- **Youth Dance Class:** Monday/Wednesday 5:00p.m.-7:00p.m. & Saturdays 9:00 -11:00 a.m. cost $10 per month per participant

Southwest Youth Athletics

- **Youth Volleyball:** Registration remains open for students grades 4th -7th the league starts on October 12. Practice is currently on Saturdays, and will play twice weekly in the league
- **Learn to Swim Program:** Weekly, lessons for all skill levels. Morning and evening class options ended September 3.
- **Water Safety Program:** Was offered to the Star Student Afterschool participants from each Community Center for 5 weeks August 25 – September 24.
- **Youth Football**: League games were played at West Central Com. Center ended on Sept.29.

Southwest Adult Programs

- **Mid-Day Art Class:** for ages 18+ last Tuesday of each month 12pm – 2pm
- **Walking Club:** Members and guest experiences walking the trails at Southwest Com. Center with a staff, miles are recorded and incentives received periodically. Currently there are 4 members.
- **Low-Impact Senior Workout**: Video-based program with about 15 members/guests age 65+.
- **Southwest Steppers Dance Workout Class:** attendance high, social media created for promotions.

****Special Events & Community Outreach:** Vibes and Versus Open Mike(postponed due to low numbers), Job Fair (City of Faith 425 registered participants), Cloverdale Neighborhood Forum (115 registered participants), Financial Literacy (3 in attendance)

****Upcoming Events:** National Night Out Oct. 6, 5 – 8pm; Chicot N' hood Association Crime Violence Forum Oct. 2, 6 – 7:30pm; Baptist Health Mobile Breast Cancer Unit (Free Mammograms Oct. 17, 9 – 1pm; Sustainability Office COLR Repair Fair Oct. 18, 10 – 2pm

Facility Vacancies: 1 Full-Time Custodian Sr., 4 Part-Time Activity assistance

Maintenance: Need water leak fixed outside playground area, Torn carpet needs to be replaced in banquet hall, Shade structures need to be removed from the pool area

Stephens Community Center

- **Star Student Afterschool:** Started August 11, there are 37 participants, 74%
- **Youth Sports Program:** Flag Football – 36; Cheerleaders - 21
- **Facility Vacancies:** 3 – part-time Activity Assistants; 2-Part-Time or 1-Full-Time Custodians.
- **Maintenance:** Leak in the ceiling at the front door. Lines on the floor for Volleyball and Youth Basketball has been completed
- **Special Activities:** LRPR Star Student- Water Safety program Aug. 25 – Sept. 24 at Southwest Community Center (Tuesdays/Thursday from 3:30 p.m. - 5:30 p.m.; Saturdays, Sept. 5 – Dec. 12, 2026 Museum of Discovery (11:00 am-12:00 pm); Monday's & Thursday's, Sept. 1 - 22. 2026 Water Safety 3:30-4:30 pm (SWCC); Wednesday, September 23, 2026, 6:00 -8:30 pm A Taste of Stephens 111 participants; Saturday, Sept. 26, 2026, Flag Football End of Season Swim Party 2:30-4:30 pm (Jim Daily)
- **Upcoming**: Youth Volleyball, 40 & Over Basketball Men's League

West Central Community Center

- **Cooling Center**: Monday through Friday, 8 a.m. to 8:30 p.m. & Saturday 9 a.m. to 5 p.m.
- **Youth Sports:** Flag Football season has started, WCCC has 64 participants, cheer has 20, and volleyball has 12.
- **Classes:** Karate 28 (3 age groups), Youth Dance 10 (on break until October), Adult Line dance 15 in Tuesday/Thursday day classes and 20 in Wednesday evening classes. Active living classes for seniors are Monday-Friday averaging about 150 participants per week.

- **Community Outreach**: Give back to our school. Parkview Girls and Boys basketball team was giving after practice treats for their hard work during preseason.
- **Programming:** September 5th the Memphis Grizzles & Arkansas Travelers came out to for our annual Mini Camp. We had 60 participants. September 26th we had our first "Friendship Day". Participants were able to paint rock for our front flower bed and plant new flowers in our outdoor flower bed.
- **Rentals:** 18 including neighborhood Associations and COLR business meetings.
- **Staffing:** 1 Act. Assistant have started and 1 is in the hiring process
- **Maintenance:** There were a few lights in the banquet hall and front desk area that were replaced with new LED lights.
- **Special Activity:** LRPR Star Student- Water Safety program August 25th – September 24th at Southwest Community Center (Tuesdays/Thursday from 3:30 p.m. - 5:30 p.m.)

ELR Community Center

- **Trainings:** Cybersecurity/Series, Safety (Job Hazard Analysis)
- **Attendance:** 301
- **Community Use:** Neighborhood Association, Grounds, Outdoor courts and park areas used 3–5 days/week for recreation, trainings, and fitness.
- **Maintenance:** Grounds & horticulture upkeep; Urban Forestry fallen tree branches removed, tennis courts in need of refurbishment, electrical, & HVAC
- **Meetings:** Staff meetings, Work Order, Neighborhood meeting 9/14 next meeting 10/12.

Senior Affairs

- **Attendance:** 3,502 all locations total
- **Community Outreach:** Baptist Health held their monthly outreach**,** monthly health screening all locations and food distributions (Dunbar/East LR & Southwest).
- **Events:** Fishing for Seniors @MacArthur Park 9/18 9:30am – 12noon. West Central: bowling, ArchWell Health, Saracen, Long Horn, and hosted a Bean Bag Baseball Tournament. Southwest: Sage Health, Speaker Rick Taylor on Palliative Care, Saracen, Humana Speaker, and Fraud Bingo. East Little Rock: Walmart, Movie @Ron Robinson Theatre, and Saracen. Dunbar: Dollar Tree, Mosaic Templar, Movie Day, and Out 2 Lunch.
- **Monthly Activities:** Chair volleyball, bean bag baseball, Birthday celebrations, Bingo/connect bingo, Bean Bag Baseball, Pickle Ball, Dominoes, Arts & Crafts, Guest Speakers, Field Trips, Bible Study, bowling, painting, Line Dancing, Mind Bending, Ring Toss, Silver Foxes Dance Class, Senior Chair Fitness, walking club, Quilting, Puzzles, Adult Coloring, Jewelry Making, Skip-Bo, Card/Table Games, and Free play

Therapeutic Recreation

- **Branch Out Adult Day Program:** Enrollment- 21, Activities: Morning movement/fitness, art projects was included in the TR aRT Gallery event, baking challenge, volleyball, archery, community outings, sports programming, group games that focus on socialization, team building and following step by step directions.
- **Time Out for TR: 19 registered,** Activity**:** Frost Your Cake, Baking/Decorating Class- Sept. 11th
- **Community Outings:** Murry's Dinner Playhouse- Sept. 3: 17 registered
- **Special Events: (1) The 3rd Annual aRT Gallery,** attendance 113 Friday, 9/18 at 6pm at MacArthur Museum of Arkansas Military History. It was a public event and featured art projects from multiple mediums created by the participants of the Branch Out program. They had 7 art

installments on display. (2) **Logan's Run**—30 registered, held on 9/26 at War Memorial Park 9:00am. A non-competitive event offered individuals ages 5 and up with intellectual, developmental, and/or physical disabilities an opportunity to enhance their physical activity while focusing on reaching a goal. It was a 2K race and is a kickoff event for the…see below

- **Upcoming Special Event**: Annual TR ReTReat Camping event will be Oct. 21-23 at Camp Aldersgate. Registration closes on Oct. 9. **2026 All-Abilities Division** of Little Rock Marathon on Saturday, Mar. 6th.
- **Upcoming Activities/Events**: The TR Branch Out group will be hosting its annual Parks Appreciation Chili Lunch at the Ottenheimer TR Center on Oct. 13th. Oct. 15- Little Rock Zoo. AR State Fair outing scheduled Oct. 19th : 22 registered. Oct. 30- Kostume Karaoke at the Ottenheimer TR Center 7:00pm-9:00pm: 20 registered
- **Misc.**: Sherrie Shinn and Ashlie Bell will attend the ARPA conference in Fort Smith, AR Oct. 14-16, and also serve on the ARPA Scholarship Auction committee.

Jim Dailey Fitness & Aquatics

- **Memberships:** 3,294 **Revenue**: $499,082.69 **Attendance:** 114,528
- **Programs:** 19 group fitness classes; strong participation. Senior fit class average 55 per class.
- **Events: Tai Chi Dailey Flow**: Date: 9/9, Time: 9:00 AM Ages: 18+ Cost: Free; **Lunch & Learn: Health and Wellness Series:** (Jim Dailey Fitness & Aquatic Center partnered with Natural Grocers) offered a series of educational Lunch & Learn sessions featured a variety of health/wellness topics Started: 9/2, Schedule: Every other Wed. Time: 12:00 PM Cost: Free; **Step Fit – New Fitness Class:** Date: 9/8, 2026 Tues.: 7:00 AM Sat.: 10:00 AM; **Pickleball Lessons** – (New) Started: 9/2, Time: 9:00 AM Ages: 10+ Cost: Daily admission or monthly membership

The Centre at University Park (Currently Under Renovation)

Youth Athletics

- **Youth Flag Football:** 156 registered, league August 24 – September 29 at West Central Com. Center. Awards have been given out.
- **Youth Cheerleading:** 72 registered, Awards are being processed.
- **Youth Volleyball:** 64 registered, League starts week of October 12.

Adult Athletics

- **Interstate Park Programs:** Field usage for Interstate Park fields 1,2 & 3 used for the Kickball league on Sundays 9am – 6pm for the next 8 weeks started in September. No games after 6pm due to getting darker earlier and lighting issues.
- **Allsop Park:** Field usage picked back up with every Thursday and Friday being reserved for the month of October.
- **Men's 40 and over league**: Scheduled to be played at Stephens Community Center on Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday Starting on October 12, 2026 and run for 8 weeks.
- **Adult Softball Program:** The professional corporate league of 14 teams league at Interstate Sports complex ended September 10 on fields 4 & 6. Also, the coed Church softball league has been postponed until spring.

First Tee Golf

- **Attendance:** 2026 - 5859
- **Activities:** 3 golf tournaments so far this year, with one more scheduled for October 16 and 17

- **Facility Vacancies:** None
- **Maintenance:** Driving ranges are in good shape. Hoping for a mild winter.
- **Revenue:** GROSS SALES YEAR/YEAR JAN,1 TO September 29, 2026, $265,700.52 JAN, 1 TO September 29, 2025, $284,864.57 **Down 6.73% (Due to cold Winter and hot Summer)**

Rebsamen Golf

- **Attendance**: 2026 - **32,814**
- **Events:** 9/11 Paul and Mary Lewis Tournament, 9/14 Central Arkansas High School Golf Match, 9/18 Paul and Mary Lewis rainout make up day.
- **Maintenance:** Partitions damaged in men's room. Chad is working on replacing.
- **Staffing:** Interviewed 8 people for Part Time cash register operator and selected 4 for hire. Hopefully we will have all vacancies filled.

Rebsamen Tennis

- **Season:** High school tennis matches through end of September, Raul and Janan fall programs started, Raul has a red ball league that continues to grow. Middle School tennis starts October 4 and lasts 4-6 weeks. USTA mixed doubles and USTA Tri-level seasons over 40 teams for these two seasons.
- **Staff:** Chip Stearns was a Coach at Ozaki Cup in Georgia this past weekend where the best Arkansas players play the best from other states in competition
- **Tournaments:** ATA 65 & over 9/26, Junior Oct 3-5 (rain in the forecast), about 140 kids from 10 states.
- **Evening Play:** With the Heat not much play during the day in beginning of month, more play after 6:00 pm each night. Near the end of month daytime play picked up some.
- **Maintenance:** Boyle Park crew blew courts for our weekend tournaments.

Museum of Arkansas Military History

- **Attendance:** September attendance was 5,142 (678 walk-ins from 36 states, 4 foreign countries (Canada, South Korea, Switzerland, and Zambia), 707 for special events, meetings, and tours, 560 virtual views, 187 for After School Programming, and 3,010 off-site) YTD attendance: 28,215.
- **Staff**: David Collins attended the National History Day Conference in Indianapolis, 8/30 – 9/2. He also represented the museum at the Mosaic Templars Cultural Center's 18th Anniversary Celebration on 9/19. Shane Lind represented the museum at the Museum of Discovery's Tinker Fest on 9/12 as well as the Old State House's Home School Resource Fair on 9/25.
- **Programs:** (1) After School Programs at Stephens, Dunbar and West Central Community Centers, (2) On-site tours for seniors from Serenity Park and 10th grade students from Chaminade Preparatory School in St. Louis, (3) Pulaski Tech Paranormal Investigation Class, (4) Arkansas Association of College History Teachers Fall meeting, and (5) Mosaic Templars Cultural Center's staff tour of the new exhibit.
- **Gift Shop Sales:** $1,190.01 (September) YTD Total: $9,951.88 (a 7% increase over 2025's record-breaking sales).
- **Fundraising:** $1,715 (September). YTD Total: $22,070.25.
- **Exhibits:** *Clara Barton: Angel of the Battlefield,* a traveling exhibit from the National Museum of Civil War Medicine in Frederick, MD opened August 1. *Through Darkness to Light: Photographs Along the Underground Railroad* opened on September 4.

- **Presentations**: (1) Museum of Discovery, Mosaic Templars Cultural Center, and the Old State House Museum, (2) "War Comes to the Ozarks" Civil War bus tour with Mark Christ.
- **Movies MacArthur:** *Time of Fear,* on 9/15 & 16. 101 attended the evening movie screening and 11 attended the matinee showing the next afternoon. YTD – 833, which is a record with two more months in the season (average of 93 per month).
- **Partnerships:** Korean American Federation of Arkansas, Republic of Korea Consulate in Houston, Little Rock Parks and Recreation Therapeutic Recreation, Museum of Discovery, Mosaic Templars Cultural Center, Old State House Museum, National Museum of Civil War Medicine, Exhibits USA and Mid-America Arts Alliance.
- **Special Events:** (1) Preview reception for new exhibit *Through Darkness to Light: Photographs Along the Underground Railroad* on 9/3, (2) Inchon Landing 76th Anniversary Commemoration on 9/15, (3) aRT Gallery reception on 9/18
- **Looking Ahead:** October 10 – 13th Annual Vintage Military Vehicle Show, 9 am – 2 pm; October 13 – Aesthetic Club begins new year; October 20 – Movies at MacArthur, *Cuban Missile Crisis: Three Men Go to War,* 6:30 – 8 pm; October 21 – Pulaski County Youth Services 6th Annual Fall Festival, 5:30 – 7:30; October 23 - 25 – 15th Annual Arkansas Paranormal Expo, 9 am – 5 pm; October 24 – "Nightmare at the Museum," Museum of Discovery, 6 – 9 pm; October 29 – 31st Annual Big Boo!seum Bash Halloween Event, 5:30 – 8:30 pm

Outdoor Recreation

- **Program Attendance:** 284 adults, 23 youth
- **Facility usage:** War Memorial disc golf course: year to date # of players: 3,208 with 5,882 hours of usage. Cross Country event at War Memorial:1287 runners, approx. 500 spectators. Therapeutic Recreation's Logan's Run at War Memorial: 50 adults, 12 youth.
- **Activities:** Wednesday, 6am Arkansas River Trail "Banana rides", Thursday, alternating Arkansas River Trail road ride and Boyle Park mountain bike rides, Disc golf event at War Memorial disc golf, ride leader for BDB100 training rides, (several programs were canceled due to excessive heat); had a booth at the BDB100 Expo and spoke with approx. 700 people; rode the BDB100 50 distance and wore the Parks & Rec jersey; fishing program for the Seniors from Dunbar and West Central.
- **Maintenance**: Ongoing upkeep of War Memorial disc golf course (brush clearing, weed eating, trash removal, equipment repair/maintenance), trash removal (averaging 5 bags a week). A water line broke in women's bathroom at the War Memorial building, flooding large part of the building. Clean-up was contracted out to Metro Disaster Specialists. The water line was repaired and the water/moister was removed. The building is now dry with no signs of permanent damage.
- **Accomplishments:** Little Rock Outdoor Recreation received the 2026 ARPA award for Excellence in a Natural Resource Programming; booth at the BDB100 Expo that normally costs $500 but due to my support of the event the booth was free. Facebook page surpassed 1,200 followers; up to date on cyber security trainings. Listed on Guide ARK as a hiking and cycling guide; November trail running event registration has reached 56 participants (this is ahead of last year's registration at the same date); group rides attendance has seen record attendance.